

Daniel Vala

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Accounting and Finance graduate from Dublin City University with First Class Honours, specialising in Data Analytics and Finance. I have a strong interest in financial markets, finance and trading – I have been investing since 15 and am now building my own algorithmic trading and backtesting framework. I am now seeking to apply these interests in a professional environment.

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EDUCATION

BA in Accounting and Finance | 2023–2026

Dublin City University

- Result: **First Class Honours**, average grade **71.64%**
- Specialism in **Finance** and **Data Analytics**
- Relevant Modules:
 - **Quantitative & Data:** Data Analytics (MS Excel, probability, statistics, business modelling, SQL, Power BI), Machine Learning & Advanced Python (ML models, ensembles, overfitting), Econometrics & Forecasting (regression, ARMA, GARCH, AIC/BIC – all in Python), Financial Mathematics
 - **Finance:** Corporate Finance (derivatives, cost of capital, portfolio theory), Financial Theory (portfolio optimisation, CAPM, APT, Fama–French, risk management)
 - **Accounting:** Financial Accounting, Management Accounting, Taxation, Audit
 - **Economics:** Microeconomics, Macroeconomics

Grammar School | 2019–2023

Gymnázium Brno, Vídeňská, Czech Republic

- School-leaving exam: **CAO points 584**

WORK EXPERIENCE

PwC | Summer 2025

Tax Intern, Financial Services Department

- Worked on live client engagements, assisting with financial data analysis and drafting risk management documentation, using MS Excel and Word
- Researched tax legislation and prepared summaries for team discussions
- Contributed to testing and improving AI use across different work processes, and delivered an AI workshop for colleagues

BEST Menswear | 2023–2025

Sales Assistant

- Worked part-time throughout my degree
- Delivered consistently high sales performance and successfully worked during two high-demand Christmas periods

Norwegian Wild | Summer 2024

Guest Assistant, Waiter and Driver

- Ran solo shifts with full responsibility for guests, solving problems independently and handling guest transport between harbour and camp
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PERSONAL PROJECTS

Algorithmic Trading & Research

- Building my own backtesting framework to develop and test systematic trading strategies (in Python)
 - Building an AI research framework and using advanced AI workflows for strategy research and development
 - Actively trading US ETF futures for the last two years, investing since the age of 15
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ACHIEVEMENTS

Economics Olympiad | 2022

13th place in the National Final hosted by the Czech National Bank (overall 30,000+ competitors)

- Final included a written test and an oral examination judged by representatives from major Czech banks and the Czech National Bank
- This competition runs across 22 countries with an international final

Secondary School Research Competition | 2022

4th place in Moravia (one of the two main regions of the Czech Republic)

- Project focussing on the economic aspect of Bitcoin and comparing it to fiat currencies
- Interviewed two leading Czech economists and defended the project in front of an expert jury

Trinity SMF x Rotman National Market Challenge | 2023

7th place

- The challenge tested the understanding of market behaviour through a trading simulation – it gave me valuable insights into institutional trading and market dynamics

PwC Award for Financial Accounting module | 2024

Placed top 10 in my class in the Financial Accounting module

PASSIONS

Competitive table tennis

- played since age 11, competed in the top regional adult league
- Best achievement: **3rd place in the Junior Regional Championship**

Hiking

Swimming

SKILLS

- **MS Excel, MS Word and Power BI** - advanced
- **Python and SQL** - used in coursework and to build my own backtesting framework (with AI)
- **AI:** AI process automation, AI coding, and AI research workflows
- **Languages:** English (fluent), Czech (native), French (intermediate)